

— CASE STUDY —



CLARKE FARM'S HOLISTIC APPROACH TO SUSTAINABLE COFFEE PRODUCTION AND COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT IN KYENJOJO DISTRICT, UGANDA



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Clarke Farm, a 1,500-acre coffee estate in Kyenjojo District, Uganda, exemplifies how agriculture can drive both economic growth and social transformation. Founded by Dr. Ian Clarke, the farm integrates sustainable coffee production, agro-tourism, and community development. With testimonies from local farmers, workers, and community members, this case study demonstrates Clarke Farm's role as a catalyst for empowerment, conservation, and cultural preservation.



BACKGROUND

Located in Uganda's coffee-growing heartland, Clarke Farm is redefining sustainable agriculture. Beyond producing premium washed Robusta coffee, the farm invests in education, health, and social welfare. Its holistic model aligns private enterprise with community needs, positioning Clarke Farm as a benchmark for agricultural entrepreneurship in East Africa.



COFFEE PRODUCTION AND PROCESSING

- 700 acres of Robusta coffee, with select Arabica plots.
- Climate-smart farming practices: soil conservation, biodiversity protection.
- On-site processing adds value, ensuring premium pricing for exports.

AGRO-TOURISM AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The Coffee Lodge offers:

- Scenic views and nature walks.
- Immersive coffee tours from cherry picking to roasting.
- Cultural experiences showcasing Uganda's coffee heritage

This agro-tourism model diversifies income and strengthens local economic growth.

SOCIAL IMPACT INITIATIVES

1. Coffee Institute – Training hub for farmers and coffee enthusiasts.
2. Coffee Education Fund – Tackles high school dropout rates by dedicating export revenue to education.
3. Community Support – Funeral food donations, health services for workers, and shared access to eucalyptus plantations for firewood and grazing.

LEADERSHIP TALKING NOTES

Dr. Ian Clarke, Founder

"Coffee is more than a crop; it's a livelihood. By investing in education and skills, we ensure that the benefits of coffee extend beyond the farm gates to the wider community."

Dr. Edward Katende, Director, Uganda Development Forum (UDF)

"Clarke Farm demonstrates how private enterprise can align with national goals. It embodies the Uganda Development Forum's vision of integrating wealth creation, sustainability, and community empowerment."



COMMUNITY TESTIMONIES

• **Mugume , Out-Grower Farmer:**

"Now I have a reliable market and training. My income has doubled, and I can send my children to school."

• **Kyarisiima , Student Beneficiary:**

"The scholarship allowed me to complete secondary school. I now dream of becoming an agricultural engineer."

• **Dianah , Coffee Lodge Employee:**

"Working at the Lodge gave me stable employment and skills. I am proud to share Uganda's coffee story."

• **Tumwine , Community Member:**

"The eucalyptus plantation benefits us with firewood and grazing, while Clarke Farm remains protected. It's a win-win."

• **Grace, Community Elder:**

"When a family loses a loved one, Clarke Farm donates food for funeral services. This compassion strengthens our bonds."

• **Byamukama, Worker:**

"When I fell ill, Clarke Farm paid my medical bills at Kilinda Health Centre. This showed our health is valued."

LESSONS LEARNED

- Integrating business with community development ensures sustainability.
- Agro-tourism diversifies income and promotes Uganda's heritage.
- Education and skills training reduce poverty and build resilience.
- Shared resources (firewood, grazing) foster trust and mutual protection.
- Worker welfare (healthcare support) boosts loyalty and productivity.

CHALLENGES

- Climate change threatens yields.
- Global coffee price fluctuations affect income stability.
- Infrastructure gaps limit efficiency and scaling.
- Balancing conservation with community resource needs.
- Sustaining social initiatives requires consistent revenue.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Expand climate-smart practices (irrigation, drought-resistant varieties).
- Strengthen market access through cooperatives and international buyers.
- Collaborate with government and partners for infrastructure investment.
- Formalize community benefit programs for sustainability.
- Scale education and health initiatives to reach more beneficiaries.
- Replicate Clarke Farm's model across other districts in Uganda.



CONCLUSION

Clarke Farm demonstrates how agriculture can be both profitable and socially responsible. By integrating coffee excellence with education, tourism, conservation, and direct community support, Dr. Clarke has built a holistic model that uplifts communities, protects the environment, and strengthens Uganda's coffee industry. The voices of farmers, students, workers, and elders—expressed in Rutooro and Rukiga—show that Clarke Farm's impact is deeply rooted in the lives of the people it serves.



AUTHOR BIO

Rev. Atuhaire Moses is a Ugandan leader and development practitioner dedicated to advancing community empowerment and sustainable growth. He serves as General Secretary of the NRM Mainstream in Kyenjojo District and as a District Councillor for Kyarusenzi Sub-County, where he champions inclusive governance.

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COLOPHON

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